

LittleReads

Amina Learns to Save

Money Skills

Ages 7–10

by LittleReads Editorial Team

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By 2009, China had become the world's largest producer of solar panels. A 30% tariff from the market.

Chapter 1: The Book She Wanted

One day, Amina saw a beautiful book in the bookshop window. It was a science encyclopedia with colourful pictures of planets, animals, and inventions.

It cost 3,000 naira.

Amina rushed inside and picked it up. "I want this!" she told her mother.

Her mother looked at the price and then at Amina. "Do you have 3,000 naira?"

Amina checked her pocket. She had 500 naira — this week's pocket money, already half spent on sweets.

"I do not," she said, her heart sinking.

"Then you will need to save for it," her mother said.

"But that would take six weeks!" said Amina. "That is forever!"

Her mother smiled. "Or it is six weeks of smart choices."

Chapter 2: Needs and Wants

That evening, Amina's mother sat with her at the kitchen table.

"Let me teach you something important," she said. "The difference between needs and wants."

"A need is something you must have to live — food, water, shelter, clothing, school supplies."

"A want is something you would like to have but do not need — sweets, toys, extra stationery."

"Both are okay," her mother continued. "But when you spend all your money on wants, you have nothing left for the things that really matter."

Amina thought about her spending. Sweets — want. Extra pencils — want. The science book — also a want, but a want that would help her learn.

"So if I stop buying so many sweets," Amina said slowly, "I can save for the book?"

Exactly.

Chapter 3: The Saving Plan

Amina made a plan:

Week 1: Save 300 naira. Spend 200 on small treats.

Week 2: Save 400 naira. Spend 100.

Week 3-6: Save as much as possible.

Her mother gave her a special piggy bank — a painted tin can with a slot on top.

"Every naira you put in is a naira closer to your goal," her mother said.

The first week was hard. When she walked past Mallam Bello's shop and smelled the sweets, her hand almost reached for her pocket.

But then she thought of the science book — the planets, the animals, the inventions — and kept walking.

"I am saving for something better," she told herself.

Chapter 4: Watching It Grow

Week after week, Amina saved. The piggy bank grew heavier.

When she reached 1,500 naira — half of her goal — she almost quit. "This is taking too long!"

But her mother said, "You are halfway there! The hardest part is the beginning, and you already did that."

Amina kept going. She found ways to save even more. She sold her old crayons to a younger child. She did extra chores for small amounts of money.

By week five, she had 2,500 naira. By week six, she had 3,200 naira.

More than enough!

Chapter 5: The Reward

Amina walked into the bookshop with her piggy bank money in an envelope and bought the science encyclopedia.

It felt different from any other purchase she had ever made.

When she bought sweets, the feeling lasted a few minutes. But this — this felt like an accomplishment.

"I earned this," she told her mother. "I saved and I waited and I did it."

Her mother hugged her. "That is the power of saving, Amina. It is not about having less fun now. It is about having something better later."

Amina read her book every night. She learned about planets, deep oceans, and electricity.

And when her next pocket money arrived on Saturday, she put 300 naira directly into her piggy bank.

Because Amina had learned that saving is not a punishment — it is a superpower.

What We Learned

- Needs and wants are different, and knowing the difference helps with money.
- Setting a savings goal makes it easier to save.
- Delayed gratification leads to bigger, better rewards.
- Earning and saving money gives a sense of accomplishment.

Discussion Questions

1. What is the difference between a need and a want?
2. Have you ever saved for something? How did it feel to finally get it?
3. What would you save for if you had pocket money every week?

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Thank you for reading!

Big Adventures for Little Readers

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